

Chapter 55-1

The name Gina left no impression on Liang Shi whatsoever.

But Zhao Xuning's expression didn't seem fake.

So her first reaction was that the original owner had once gone to see a psychologist.

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, remaining silent for a moment before saying, "And then?"

Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow, her cold and indifferent face showing a few traces of inscrutability: "Nothing then, we just chatted for a bit."

"Related to me?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning looked straight at her, "What do you think?"

The two went back and forth, neither giving a definitive answer.

Question against question in a battle to see whose psychological defenses would crumble first.

Continuing like this, they definitely wouldn't get any effective information.

But Liang Shi knew that to extract information from someone like Zhao Xuning, she had to first give her enough information.

Especially since this was for her own sake.

Every piece of information related to the original owner was very important now.

The original owner was unwilling to share those painful memories, and she couldn't possibly rely on stumbling upon key objects by chance to trigger all memories, so starting from the real world was the fastest approach.

As long as things had happened, they would inevitably leave traces.

Liang Shi's mind went through a storm. She pressed her temples and let out a light sigh.

She made eye contact with Zhao Xuning.

During rest time, Zhao Xuning wore plain glasses, which softened her sharp edges somewhat, making her look like a lake that could reflect all of one's thoughts.

She sat there with elegant posture, her expression calm. When she met Liang Shi's gaze, she was neither arrogant nor impatient.

After a long while, Liang Shi lowered her voice and asked, "Can I trust you?"

Zhao Xuning didn't answer directly. She gently rotated the ceramic cup in her hand, lifted it to take a sip of coffee, then used her fingertip to wipe away the lipstick mark on the cup rim. Her thin lips parted slightly, "Don't use those you suspect; don't suspect those you use."

Liang Shi suddenly laughed. She leaned back in her chair, and after laughing enough, she sat up straight, reached for her coat from the side, tilted her head toward Zhao Xuning, and invited in a relaxed tone, "Let's go, Dr. Zhao. We'll talk in the car."

Originally, Zhao Xuning was going to go to her car with Liang Shi, but when they got outside, Liang Shi directly handed over the initiative, "Let's go to your car."

Zhao Xuning frowned but quickly relaxed.

Understanding her intention, she smiled knowingly, "Alright."

Zhao Xuning's car was parked by the roadside with privacy film—you could see outside from inside, but not inside from outside.

The privacy was very good.

This was during peak hours, and two beautiful women with excellent figures walking together had nearly a 100% head-turning rate.

But both Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning ignored the passersby's gazes.

After getting in the car, Liang Shi spoke first, "I, or rather Liang Shi, have self-harmed before."

She laid out her cards to Zhao Xuning.

Upon hearing this, Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow, but her first concern wasn't about the self-harm, but about the first half of the sentence, "You, or Liang Shi? Then who exactly are you?"

"My name is Liang Shi," Liang Shi said. "But I'm not the original Liang Shi. During that hospital incident, I truly did have memory loss. I don't remember many things about that person, but recently I've gradually regained some memories. I originally lived in another world and had another identity."

Zhao Xuning looked at her and after a moment asked very seriously, "Have you been examined by psychiatry?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She said helplessly, "Didn't you say don't suspect those you use?"

"But I reasonably suspect this is a form of split personality," Zhao Xuning approached from a medical perspective. "Some people, under great real-world pressure, fantasize about a different past and believe they are someone else."

"I can clearly state that it's not," Liang Shi said. "I don't know what happened to bring me here to become another Liang Shi, but during the process of memory recovery, I discovered many things, so I want to ask for your help."

This was also Liang Shi's purpose in laying her cards on the table.

Even as calm and rational as she was, Zhao Xuning had a moment of questioning reality upon hearing this. She looked at Liang Shi: "Then why are you telling me this? If I called a research institute right now, you'd be taken away for experiments."

Liang Shi smiled gently, revealing her least harmful yet sharpest weapon, and answered firmly, "You won't."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

She raised an eyebrow with a hint of wickedness, "How do you know I won't?"

As if trying to undermine Liang Shi's confidence, she sneered coldly, "Liang Shi, don't forget, I also grew up in scheming and intrigue. You think too highly of my kindness."

"It's not that I think highly of your kindness," Liang Shi said. "You are inherently kind."

She paused and added, "Or perhaps I should say you're a person of integrity."

Zhao Xuning: "Hmm?"

"You never show blind kindness. After Bai Weiwei was in danger, you could use every method to save her, but after she didn't understand you, you decisively gave up on that friendship. You're very rational," Liang Shi said. "You might have evil thoughts, but you would never act on them because you're a person of integrity. Your moral baseline is higher than most people's. Even if you don't like me, you wouldn't backstab me, because when I entrust my trust to you, you feel a sense of responsibility."

The car fell into a long silence.

Then Liang Shi smiled warmly and said, "This is why I trust you. Besides, we're friends now, aren't we? If I can't even trust you, I don't know who else I can trust here."

Zhao Xuning: "Nonsense."

Liang Shi: "There's also Xu Qingzhu."

Both spoke almost simultaneously.

Then they looked at each other and laughed.

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After laughing enough, Zhao Xuning said, "You're quite good at reading people."

Liang Shi didn't act modest either, "Indeed, not bad."

She had dropped out of high school and then been immersed in the great melting pot of society for years, and had witnessed all aspects of human nature in the entertainment industry.

All in all, she was much more accurate at reading people than her peers.

So after coming here, she felt that Zhao Xuning was someone worth befriending.

Even if they couldn't become friends, she was very worthy of respect.

"Let's get to the point then," Zhao Xuning said. "Gina's Chinese name is Zheng Feiran. She's Dr. Gu's senior sister and currently works in the Mental Health Department at Second People's Hospital. She had been abroad before and only recently returned to the country. When I got the identification results for that button, I happened to be having dinner with her, and she accidentally saw your name, so we chatted for a bit."

"Would a psychologist reveal a patient's condition?" Liang Shi frowned.

Zhao Xuning shook her head. "Absolutely not, so I don't know what you went to see her about. The information she gave me was that you had once been her patient, but later disappeared without explanation and stopped accepting treatment."

Liang Shi thought for a moment. "Are you sure she was talking about me? Did you exchange photos to confirm?"

It wasn't impossible that there were people with the same name.

"Yes," Zhao Xuning was always meticulous in her work. What Liang Shi had thought of, she naturally had considered as well. "She showed me a photo. You were quite... unique back then."

She wracked her brain to come up with this non-insulting idiom.

But the original owner in Liang Shi's memory did indeed have a distinctive style.

After coming here, what Liang Shi found most unbearable was the original owner's aesthetic sense, always using all sorts of strange things to package herself.

But now she seemed to understand a bit.

The original owner's distorted aesthetic was a form of self-protection.

For instance, she liked flamboyant colors to give people the psychological hint: I'm not to be messed with.

She also liked clothes with studs, which looked intimidating and made people afraid to bully her.

She felt ashamed of her previously shallow thoughts.

"Do you have her contact information?" Liang Shi asked. "As her patient, I should be able to get all my medical records, right?"

Zhao Xuning gave her Gina's contact information without hesitation.

After that, she asked nothing else.

After saving the number, Liang Shi waited for Zhao Xuning's interrogation. She had revealed such a huge amount of information—surely Zhao Xuning would have many questions to ask?

Any normal person would subject her to a thorough questioning.

She was already prepared.

But unexpectedly, Zhao Xuning sat in the driver's seat, opened a mini-game app—a management-type game—and said nothing.

Liang Shi couldn't sit still first and tentatively asked, "Aren't you going to ask me anything?"

Zhao Xuning's finger tapping the screen paused. "Ask what?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Like where I came from? What my original world was like? Where did the original Liang Shi go after I came? Will she come back? Things like that," Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning closed her phone and casually tossed it aside, her tone indifferent: "Not interested."

Liang Shi: "?"

Zhao Xuning said, "The more I know, the more I'll need to help you."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Currently, I don't really want to get involved in this matter," Zhao Xuning flexed her wrist. "The hospital keeps me busy enough. I don't have the leisure to mind your affairs."

Liang Shi: "..."

Truly worthy of the rationally extreme Zhao Xuning.

Liang Shi couldn't help but be curious: "Has nothing ever happened in your life that made you lose control?"

Zhao Xuning: "?"

She slowly turned to look at Liang Shi with an incomprehensible expression.

The look made Liang Shi's heart flutter, and she immediately said, "I was just asking casually."

Zhao Xuning turned back, her voice still cold: "Xu Qingzhu asked me the same question."

Liang Shi: "..."

"From a certain perspective, you two are quite compatible," Zhao Xuning said.

Liang Shi: "..."

At the mention of Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi felt a bit embarrassed.

She didn't know where this shyness came from.

She pinched her earlobe and immediately changed the subject: "So how did you answer?"

Zhao Xuning's tone was light and airy: "None of your business."

Liang Shi: "..."

Truly you, Zhao Xuning.

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After telling Zhao Xuning about this matter, Liang Shi felt an indescribable sense of relief.

It was that feeling of not having to live in this world using another person's identity.

Someone knew that I am me.

This was a state that was very difficult to express in words, making Liang Shi so happy that she wanted to invite Zhao Xuning to dinner. But Zhao Xuning said she still had to work the night shift and seriously declined her invitation.

She also told her not to try to get closer.

"..."

However, Zhao Xuning did ask her one question: "Regarding your situation, how much does Xu Qingzhu know?"

"Seventy percent," Liang Shi answered. "We also share a lot of information between us."

Zhao Xuning paused for a moment. "Aren't you afraid I'll tell others about this? When you reveal a secret, no matter how reliable the person is, there's always a risk of it being leaked."

"Don't use those you suspect; don't suspect those you use." Liang Shi threw her own words back at her.

Zhao Xuning frowned slightly, then said, "Don't be too confident about everything."

Liang Shi knew she was giving her guidance and replied warmly, "The moment a secret is spoken, it's no longer a secret. By telling you this, I'm showing that I'm prepared for all the worst outcomes, including you sending me to a research institute."

"Have you thought of countermeasures too?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Liang Shi smiled. "At worst, I'll be treated as mentally ill."

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Liang Shi's voice was gentle, but her expression was firm, making people involuntarily follow her emotions. "What you gain and what you give are always proportional. When I choose to hand you the knife handle, I must consider the possibility that you might stab me in a vital spot. I'm willing to pay the price for my poor judgment of character."

Liang Shi wanted to gain Zhao Xuning's trust, so she had to pay a price.

And this payment might push her into a desperate situation.

Rather than saying she trusted Zhao Xuning, it was more accurate to say she trusted her own judgment and intuition.

But she couldn't be so confident as to think she would never make a mistake.

So she was prepared to be backstabbed.

Even though that possibility was minimal.

But this was the price she was willing to pay for her choice.

Nothing could have only benefits without drawbacks.

If she could bear the good, she could naturally bear the bad as well.

This was why she was going all in.

She could handle it.

Her tone was calm, but the feeling it conveyed was shocking.

Zhao Xuning sat there frozen.

After a long while, she curled her lips. "You're quite interesting."

"You used to be an actress?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Liang Shi nodded. "Yes."

After that, Zhao Xuning didn't ask her any more questions, just casually chatted about things related to the original owner.

She said she had disliked the original owner because she had too much hostility, thinking everyone was out to harm her, like she had persecution paranoia. But such a person would also hurt others, participating in some bullying incidents, using strength to oppress the weak, and having an improper private life.

Liang Shi told her about Qi Jiao's situation, and also mentioned that she wasn't the Liang family's biological daughter.

Moreover, she had already fallen out with the Liang family and would probably have to move out of the Shallow Bay villa before long.

Zhao Xuning felt a headache coming on. She pressed her temples. "You haven't been here long, but you've caused quite a lot of trouble."

Liang Shi: "...It's okay."

"So do you also know where the Liang family's biological daughter is?" Zhao Xuning asked with precision.

After thinking, Liang Shi nodded. "Sort of."

"Planning to tell the Liang family?"

"Not currently."

She wasn't an idiot. Knowing clearly that everything was disadvantageous to her, why would she still do it out of misplaced saintly compassion?

If she escaped her current predicament and the Liang family posed no harm to her, then telling them about the real heiress would be acceptable.

But obviously now wasn't the time!

She still needed to investigate many things. Based on the information she currently had, the real heiress returning wouldn't be easy to deal with either.

People skilled at manipulating public opinion and people's hearts were never simple.

With her acting skills, she could put on a show of retreating to advance—after all, her two brothers were genuinely good to her. But she couldn't convince herself to act in front of two brothers who treated people sincerely.

It was meaningless.

Liang Shi had thought through all of this very clearly, and her logic was sound when she explained it to Zhao Xuning.

Zhao Xuning only said heavily, "As long as you've thought it through."

Liang Shi: "Why are you so dejected?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

After two seconds of silence, she said gloomily, "I don't really want to know so much about your affairs."

Liang Shi was stunned and laughed silently.

When it was time to part ways, Zhao Xuning had already driven the car out a distance, then reversed back, rolled down the window, and said in an unusually cold and serious tone, "I have an apartment in Linjiang District. If you need it, I can rent it to you as a transition."

Liang Shi: "...!"

Her eyes lit up. "Thank you, Dr. Zhao!"

Zhao Xuning drove away with an expression of speechlessness.

Standing there, Liang Shi suddenly realized that Zhao Xuning was even more of a gentleman than she had imagined.

Chapter 55-4

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Liang Shi didn't dare delay. After parting ways with Zhao Xuning, she immediately contacted the psychologist Gina.

Gina was shocked when she received her call, but still arranged a meeting time with her.

It was a rest day, so Gina wasn't at the hospital.

After inquiring about the address, they discovered they weren't far from each other, so Gina directly invited Liang Shi to her home.

Gina's home was on the top floor of a high-end residential complex, on the 32nd floor accessible by elevator.

When Liang Shi entered, she was greeted by a white Pomeranian. The dog had originally been excitedly welcoming the guest, but upon seeing her, its face immediately drooped, fear showing in its eyes as it wagged its tail and ran away. The sound of the bell around its neck echoed throughout the house.

Standing at the door, Gina noticed her puzzled expression and said, "She probably still has trauma from you."

Liang Shi: "..."

Did the original owner also harm small animals?

Gina was a very tall woman with brown curly long hair, single eyelids, no makeup, and yellow skin. She gave off a very comfortable feeling.

Only she and the Pomeranian lived in the house. The little dog quietly nestled in a corner, as if it didn't exist.

Gina led Liang Shi into the study.

Her study had a very special layout.

Liang Shi had previously acted in dramas about psychological counselors, so she had some knowledge about counseling rooms.

This study was a very typical psychological counseling room—the wall clock, the placement of the sofas, the green plants on the windowsill, and the small decorative items on her desk.

Upon entering, it would give those in the know a sense of psychological pressure.

Although the room was brightly lit and looked refreshing at first glance.

"Please sit," Gina said, taking out a manila envelope from her drawer. "I heard you lost your memory?"

Liang Shi coughed lightly: "I remember some parts, but I don't remember you."

"Should we continue our psychological therapy?" Gina asked. "Or would you prefer to register anew at our hospital?"

"No need," Liang Shi said. "I don't have any major psychological problems now. I just want to understand my previous situation."

"If you're better now, I wouldn't recommend you learning about the past," Gina paused and said. "By whatever means, you've already healed yourself. Learning about the past might trigger painful memories and return you to your previous state."

"But a person without a past is incomplete," Liang Shi said. "I still hope to understand."

Gina stared at her for a while, then handed her the therapy files.

As Liang Shi was opening the envelope, Gina continued, "You became my patient when you were 18 years old. There were only five sessions over two months. Later, you forcibly withdrew from therapy, and I went abroad. I remember you very clearly because of your defensive mechanisms."

Gina couldn't help but sigh at this point, "I'm very curious about what you've experienced in all these years."

Halfway through reading the files, Liang Shi looked up and smiled—a very kind smile. "Perhaps I experienced love."

"..."

Gina paused. "Love is indeed the cure for everything."

When Liang Shi left Gina's house with the original owner's psychological therapy records from when she was 18, her mood was somewhat heavy, but she still said goodbye to Gina warmly.

However, Gina said, "Next time, we can chat about what happened to you these years."

Liang Shi smiled. "Sure."

After leaving Gina's house, she drove home.

On the road, she kept her speed very slow, her mind weighed down with concerns, afraid she might cause an accident if she drove too fast.

Chapter 55-5

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Shallow Bay.

Xu Qingzhu was sitting on the living room sofa watching TV—a rare moment of rest for her.

Hearing the door, Xu Qingzhu looked over and met Liang Shi's gaze.

In that instant, she saw Liang Shi's reddened eyes.

Xu Qingzhu turned off the TV, placed the remote on the coffee table, and asked with a somewhat relaxed smile, "Teacher Liang, what grievance have you suffered?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together and instinctively replied, "Nothing."

But when she answered, her voice was choked.

Even the ending tone was trembling.

Xu Qingzhu immediately frowned and stood up, walking toward her.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi placed the manila envelope at the entrance and bent down to change her shoes.

When she stood up again, her legs went weak and she almost fell. Xu Qingzhu was quick to catch her, and then Liang Shi's body weight leaned entirely on Xu Qingzhu.

Seeing her abnormal state, Xu Qingzhu softened her voice and asked, "What happened?"

"Let me recover for a moment," Liang Shi tried to speak normally.

"Take your time," Xu Qingzhu comforted her. "No rush."

She helped Liang Shi to the sofa, where Liang Shi curled up in the corner like a ball—a very defensive posture.

Xu Qingzhu poured her a glass of honey water and gently coaxed, "Drink a little."

Liang Shi's fingers were trembling as she took the glass—she had to use both hands to hold it steady.

She took several gulps, water droplets falling to the corners of her lips, which she didn't even think to wipe away.

Xu Qingzhu asked, "Did you drive home in this state?"

Liang Shi closed her eyes, "I drove very slowly. Can you wait for me to recover?"

"Of course," Xu Qingzhu placed the glass aside and quietly waited for her emotions to settle.

In front of Gina, Liang Shi didn't dare show any abnormality.

She was afraid Gina would see through her vulnerability and establish a doctor-patient relationship with her again.

On the drive home, she was also afraid of having an accident, so she forced herself to concentrate on watching the road.

It wasn't until now, after returning home, that her taut nerves finally relaxed.

Her head was buried between her knees, her whole being appearing fragile.

Xu Qingzhu sat beside her watching, then noticed the manila envelope by her side and asked softly, "May I look?"

Liang Shi's body swayed slightly, and she muffled a response: "Mm."

Xu Qingzhu opened the manila envelope, which contained detailed records of Liang Shi's psychological therapy sessions from when she was 18.

Very detailed question-and-answer sessions.

The first couple of sessions weren't particularly special—Liang Shi's responses to all questions were simple and crude.

Either "I don't want to talk" or "None of your business."

The doctor's diagnosis at the end was: Bipolar disorder with severe defensive mechanisms.

It was from the third session that Liang Shi opened her heart and began saying incoherent things.

[I have no childhood memories. I don't remember how I came to be here, but my family is very wealthy.]

[I really like this family, but my mother doesn't like me.]

[It doesn't matter, I don't need her to like me, but she says she loves me very much, and everyone says she loves me.]

[I have endless money to spend, and I believed my mother liked me.]

[I got seriously ill, but that illness happened because my mother accidentally pushed me into the frozen sea, yet my mother said it was evil spirits.]

[I want to destroy this world, it's too dark.]

[I want to kill people, animals will do too.]

[Only blood can keep me clear-headed.]

[Later I discovered maybe I don't need blood, I found another way.]

[What way? Why should I tell you?]

[I don't want treatment anymore.]

[I'm not sick, I just like playing exciting games.]

[...]

In the third, fourth, and fifth therapy sessions, her words were all very chaotic.

But it was clear that her mental state was abnormal.

Xu Qingzhu quickly skimmed through these materials, then asked Liang Shi, "Did you experience these things or did she?"

Liang Shi's emotions had calmed down somewhat, and she shook her head: "I'm not sure."

It seemed like the residual memories in this body were reminding her of everything that had happened in the past.

Her empathic abilities originally would only make her feel heartache, but nowhere near to this extent.

Since returning here, her hands and feet had been shaking continuously.

So she felt it might be the original owner causing trouble.

Her soul was restless and agitated, and this body was becoming restless along with it.

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Liang Shi tried her best to remain calm and rational. "I just felt very distressed after seeing these things, the kind of distress where I couldn't catch my breath."

As soon as she finished speaking, a tear fell.

Completely beyond her control.

It seemed as if the original owner was very unwilling for her to know these memories.

Liang Shi closed her eyes and clenched her fists. She opened her mouth, but before she could speak again, more tears fell.

Xu Qingzhu immediately patted her back gently, comforting her in a warm voice, "It's okay, it's okay, I'm here."

Liang Shi's body trembled uncontrollably. She called out softly, "Xu Qingzhu."

Her voice was incredibly fragile, as if she might collapse at any moment.

Xu Qingzhu immediately responded, "I'm here."

Liang Shi stretched out her legs, reaching her hand toward Xu Qingzhu. Just suspended in the air, it was shaking violently. "I feel so... so sad."

In this moment, it seemed as if the original owner's emotions had taken control.

Her powerful empathy became a weapon for the original owner to vent emotions, and she herself could no longer maintain rationality.

"Then cry it out," Xu Qingzhu said, looking at her. She stepped forward and embraced her, holding her tightly, patting her back like comforting a child. "It's okay, Liang Shi, I'm still here."

Liang Shi closed her eyes, her heart feeling as if it had sunk into an ice cellar.

Too many complex emotions had accumulated, completely beyond what words could describe.

It was as if she wasn't herself.

Her emotions had merged with the original owner's.

She could completely feel the original owner's pain.

It was an indescribable despair.

The sadness of seeing no light, no future.

She urgently longed to grasp something to prove her existence.

So at this moment, she turned and hugged Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu's slender waist was tightly encircled in her arms, her arms tightening, pressing her whole body close to herself.

As if only this way could she feel that she was still alive.

Xu Qingzhu was hugged so tightly she could barely breathe, but she still softened her voice to comfort her, "Liang Shi, it will all pass."

Her slender fingers came together, gently stroking her hair.

Liang Shi felt her gentle aura but still wanted to absorb more.

Alphas were naturally strong, so she easily lifted Xu Qingzhu up, directly placing her on her own lap.

Her two slender legs spread apart on either side of the sofa, her long hair falling across her fingers.

Xu Qingzhu's hair was very smooth, carrying the scent of cherry blossoms, as if the entire spring had settled on her.

Liang Shi buried her head to lightly sniff the fragrance in her hair, but still felt it wasn't enough.

She could smell not only the cherry blossom scent, but also the faint aroma of strawberry Baileys. Her body seemed beyond her own control.

Her eyes were crying, yet her body felt as if something was awakening.

Xu Qingzhu finally couldn't bear it. She leaned close to Liang Shi's ear and whispered, "Liang Shi, you're hurting me."

Liang Shi's head was buried in her neck, and she couldn't help but extend her tongue tip to lick her skin.

As if wanting to possess spring without restraint, to merge it into her own soul.

Upon feeling that patch of moisture, Xu Qingzhu's body trembled slightly. She bit her lip, "Liang Shi, let me go first."

But Liang Shi seemed unable to understand her words. She said in a low voice, "Let me hold you a little longer."

Her voice was full of fragility, like fragile glass.

Ready to shatter at the slightest touch.

Xu Qingzhu didn't move anymore. She felt the burning heat that only came during heat periods.

Though separated by two layers of clothing, they were truly embracing.

Her body was also changing silently.

Sometimes, embraces could stimulate the senses more than kisses.

Her hand gently pinched Liang Shi's shoulder, lightly biting her lip until it became bright red and glistening.

Like an enchanting rose in early spring touched by morning dew, waiting to be picked.

She couldn't bear this heat and shifted slightly, changing positions.

But the hand on her waist also changed position, moving down from her waist, easily slipping under her hem. Her fingers carried burning temperature, like a ball of fire.

At the same time, she felt even more moist heat at her neck.

Liang Shi was like a vampire, attached to her neck, her teeth gently biting her skin.

She felt no pain, but it made her whole body go soft.

A sensation more terrifying than heat periods arose from within her body, and she let out a muffled moan.

Hearing this moan, Liang Shi seemed encouraged. Her flame-like hand moved upward, easily reaching that tender place.

So hot it nearly melted Xu Qingzhu.

But it didn't make Xu Qingzhu lose her rationality. Her hand, through the clothes, grasped Liang Shi's hand, saying gently, "Liang Shi, calm down a little."

An Omega's body was really too easily aroused.

Clearly she was still rational, but her voice had already taken on a hoarse quality, her clear voice carrying a hint of huskiness, sounding like she was playing hard to get.

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Xu Qingzhu bit her lip and used all her remaining strength, "Calm down."

Liang Shi's hand paused, her head buried in Xu Qingzhu's neck, breathing heavily.

Her breathing was labored, and each breath released hot air that nearly burned Xu Qingzhu's skin.

Xu Qingzhu felt as if her own body had been set on fire.

Unprecedented sensations appeared in her body, making her seem to yearn for something.

But she knew this was wrong.

Liang Shi found it very difficult to calm down at this moment. She pleaded in a low voice, "Can I... can I bite you once?"

Like a child saying, "Can I have a piece of candy?"

Very hard to refuse.

Xu Qingzhu hesitated, but Liang Shi's arm around her waist tightened once more, holding her entire body close.

The two were too close, so close that Xu Qingzhu had difficulty breathing.

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes, deciding to indulge her slightly. She rested her head on Liang Shi's shoulder, pulled the hand that had slipped under her clothes out, and held her burning hand.

As if resigned to fate, she said gently, "Just once."

Upon hearing this, Liang Shi's teeth settled on her neck.

She wasn't really biting, but rather gently rubbing, then relaxing, then biting again.

It didn't hurt, but it was somewhat ticklish.

Xu Qingzhu's hand tightly gripped hers, her whole body buried in Liang Shi's neck.

If she wanted, she could easily bite Liang Shi's neck in the same way.

But she didn't.

She passively endured everything Liang Shi brought to her.

Fortunately, Liang Shi didn't make any further advances.

The living room was filled with rich pheromone scents, mixed together so it was impossible to tell whose was whose.

Liang Shi was like a child eating candy, reluctant to bite the candy to pieces, instead slowly savoring it.

That tingling sensation spread throughout Xu Qingzhu's body.

She relied on strong willpower to keep herself from making any sounds, because she was afraid her voice would make Liang Shi even more agitated.

At this moment, Liang Shi seemed to be experiencing something.

Liang Shi's emotions calmed down slightly. She was breathing heavily, and Xu Qingzhu said softly, "Let me down."

Liang Shi didn't speak.

After an unknown amount of time, she suddenly erupted, grabbing Xu Qingzhu's hand in return, then shifting her entire position, directly throwing Xu Qingzhu, who had been sitting on her, onto the sofa.

And she immediately leaned over her.

Under the Alpha's powerful suppression, Xu Qingzhu couldn't exert any strength at all.

She lay on the sofa looking at Liang Shi, whose originally gentle and smiling eyes were now bloodshot, as if she had been crying for a long time. She seemed to be suppressing something within her body, but couldn't suppress it.

Rich pheromones continuously emanated, carrying the Alpha's pheromone scent with a hint of crisp white tea fragrance, making even the Omega blush.

Although Xu Qingzhu had taken suppressants, at this moment the sufficiently rich Alpha pheromones entering her nostrils could still arouse her body's desires.

It was a physiologically irresistible desire.

Her remaining rationality made her kick at Liang Shi, but her two slender legs were easily suppressed by Liang Shi.

Who even forcefully spread her legs apart.

Xu Qingzhu felt a trace of shame.

She looked at Liang Shi, "What do you want to do?"

Liang Shi also stared at her, those glistening lips making one want to kiss them.

As if just kissing them could relieve her current suffering.

But she couldn't.

She mustn't.

Liang Shi's head felt like it was about to explode, the pain from her body making her long to embrace, to kiss, to do all manner of crazy things.

In the end, body triumphed over reason. All rationality crumbled in an instant. She leaned down, using one hand to restrain both of Xu Qingzhu's hands while the other pushed up her pajama top.

"Liang Shi, are you crazy?" Xu Qingzhu called out to her.

This cry instantly pulled Liang Shi's rationality back. Her eyes showed a moment of confusion, and she released the strength in her hands.

Then she rolled to the inside of the sofa.

She looked up at the ceiling, closed her eyes, and directly fainted.

Chapter 55-8

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Hospital.

Xu Qingzhu stood in the hospital corridor, leaning against the wall without much energy.

Zhao Xuning walked over and handed her a carton of milk.

Xu Qingzhu said softly, "Thank you."

But Zhao Xuning glanced at Liang Shi lying unconscious in the hospital room, opened her drink, took a gulp, and said, "She became like this after seeing Zheng Feiran?"

"Yes, she was particularly fragile after coming home," Xu Qingzhu said. "Her whole body was shaking."

"Probably because she was severely traumatized," Zhao Xuning said. "She didn't hurt you, did she?"

"No," Xu Qingzhu said.

It was completely different from before.

Even when Liang Shi was on the edge of collapse, she still asked for Xu Qingzhu's opinion.

Asking her: "Can I bite you once?"

Zhao Xuning frowned, "She's having two susceptible periods a month¹, probably due to severe trauma. What was written in those reports?"

Xu Qingzhu didn't hide anything from her—the two had already exchanged information.

After hearing everything, Zhao Xuning frowned slightly.

She had Xu Qingzhu repeat those words again.

—I discovered another way.

—Why should I tell you? I just like playing exciting games.

Zhao Xuning was silent for a moment, then said, "I have a theory."

Xu Qingzhu felt uneasy but still asked, "What?"

Zhao Xuning paused, "The original Liang Shi might have had sex addiction."

Xu Qingzhu leaned against the wall in silence.

Zhao Xuning asked, "What do you think?"

After a long while, Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes and sighed, "Probably."

She had also noticed that the original Liang Shi was very fond of that kind of thing.

Whenever she was restless and agitated, she definitely needed to do it.

If Xu Qingzhu wouldn't comply, she would definitely find someone else.

She needed this way to divert her attention.

Zhao Xuning said, "Although she claims to come from another world, I'm more inclined to think she has split personality disorder."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her temples, her voice weary: "This is all so complicated."

"So, let's not think about it for now," Zhao Xuning said. "Just pretend we don't know."

Xu Qingzhu said helplessly, "We've already entered her world, how can we pretend not to know?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

She looked at Xu Qingzhu and suddenly asked very seriously, "So do you like her now?"

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together and shook her head, "I don't know."

The emotions were too complex.

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes and spoke honestly to Zhao Xuning: "She's a very charismatic person who makes people involuntarily trust her, get close to her, and befriend her. She takes meticulous care of me, seeping into my life like water, but I don't want to like people anymore."

Zhao Xuning leaned against the wall beside her, listening quietly.

Xu Qingzhu said in a muffled voice, "What is love anyway? It's too exhausting."

Zhao Xuning seemed to recall something, her voice tender, "I don't know either."

"If she were a completely new person, would you love her?" Zhao Xuning suddenly asked softly.

It was unclear whether she was asking Xu Qingzhu or asking someone else through Xu Qingzhu.

"A person cannot step into the same river twice," a sudden female voice interrupted, sharp and cold.

Zhao Xuning and Xu Qingzhu looked in the direction of the voice to see Shen Hui standing not far away, wearing black knee-high boots and a gray coat.

Seeing their synchronized movements, Shen Hui curved her lips in a smile, her expression mocking and cold, "Looks like I'm interrupting Dr. Zhao's romantic conversation again."

¹ In ABO dynamics, "susceptible periods" refer to times when an Alpha or Omega is more sensitive to pheromones and may experience heightened sexual or emotional responses, similar to but distinct from heat/rut cycles.